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Inventor(s)	Elshafie; Ahmed et al.

Techniques for path information-based physical layer security

Abstract

Aspects described herein relate to transmitting and/or receiving devices securing or authenticating communications at a physical layer based on generated or received path information.

Inventors: Elshafie; Ahmed (San Diego, CA), Ly; Hung Dinh (San Diego, CA), Manolakos; Alexandros (Escondido, CA)

Applicant: QUALCOMM Incorporated (San Diego, CA)

Family ID: 86904300

Assignee: QUALCOMM Incorporated (San Diego, CA)

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Primary Examiner: Sarker; Sanchit K

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Arent Fox, LLP

Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Aspects of the present disclosure relate generally to wireless communication systems, and more particularly, to securing physical layer communications.

(2) Wireless communication systems are widely deployed to provide various types of communication content such as voice, video, packet data, messaging, broadcast, and so on. These systems may be multiple-access systems capable of supporting communication with multiple users by sharing the available system resources (e.g., time, frequency, and power). Examples of such multiple-access systems include code-division multiple access (CDMA) systems, time-division multiple access (TDMA) systems, frequency-division multiple access (FDMA) systems, and orthogonal frequency-division multiple access (OFDMA) systems, and single-carrier frequency division multiple access (SC-FDMA) systems.

(3) These multiple access technologies have been adopted in various telecommunication standards to provide a common protocol that enables different wireless devices to communicate on a municipal, national, regional, and even global level. For example, a fifth generation (5G) wireless communications technology (which can be referred to as 5G new radio (5G NR)) is envisaged to expand and support diverse usage scenarios and applications with respect to current mobile network generations. In an aspect, 5G communications technology can include: enhanced mobile broadband addressing human-centric use cases for access to multimedia content, services and data; ultra-reliable-low latency communications (URLLC) with certain specifications for latency and reliability; and massive machine type communications, which can allow a very large number of connected devices and transmission of a relatively low volume of non-delay-sensitive information.

SUMMARY

(4) The following presents a simplified summary of one or more aspects in order to provide a basic understanding of such aspects. This summary is not an extensive overview of all contemplated aspects, and is intended to neither identify key or critical elements of all aspects nor delineate the scope of any or all aspects. Its sole purpose is to present some concepts of one or more aspects in a simplified form as a prelude to the more detailed description that is presented later.

(5) According to an aspect, an apparatus for wireless communication is provided that includes a transceiver, a memory configured to store instructions, and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the memory and the transceiver. The one or more processors are configured to generate path information for each of multiple reference signals received over one of multiple different paths from a transmitting device, and at least one of: decode communications received from the transmitting device based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals; encode communications for transmitting to the transmitting device based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals; or authenticate communications received from the transmitting device based on comparing received path information of the communications with the path information for one of the multiple different paths indicated for the communications.

(6) In another aspect, an apparatus for wireless communication is provided that includes a transceiver, a memory configured to store instructions; and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the memory and the transceiver. The one or more processors are configured to transmit, to a receiving device, multiple reference signals over multiple different paths, receive, from the receiving device, path information for each of the multiple reference signals, and at least one of: encode, based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals, communications for transmitting to the receiving device; decode, based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals, communications received from the receiving device; or transmit, to the receiving device, communications over one of the multiple different paths, wherein the communications include a parameter indicating the one of the multiple different paths over which the communications are transmitted.

(7) In another aspect, a method for wireless communication is provided that includes generating, by a receiving device, path information for each of multiple reference signals received over one of multiple different paths from a transmitting device, and at least one of: decoding communications received from the transmitting device based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals; encoding communications for transmitting to the transmitting device based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals; or authenticating communications received from the transmitting device based on comparing received path information of the communications with the path information for one of the multiple different

paths indicated for the communications.

(8) In yet another aspect, a method for wireless communication is provided that includes transmitting, to a receiving device, multiple reference signals over multiple different paths, receiving, from the receiving device, path information for each of the multiple reference signals, and at least one of: encoding, based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals, communications for transmitting to the receiving device; decoding, based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals, communications received from the receiving device; or transmitting, to the receiving device, communications over one of the multiple different paths, wherein the communications include a parameter indicating the one of the multiple different paths over which the communications are transmitted.

(9) In further aspects, an apparatus for wireless communication is provided that includes a transceiver, a memory configured to store instructions, and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the transceiver and the memory. The one or more processors are configured to execute the instructions to perform the operations of methods described herein. In another aspect, an apparatus for wireless communication is provided that includes means for performing the operations of methods described herein. In yet another aspect, a computer-readable medium is provided including code executable by one or more processors to perform the operations of methods described herein.

(10) To the accomplishment of the foregoing and related ends, the one or more aspects comprise the features hereinafter fully described and particularly pointed out in the claims. The following description and the annexed drawings set forth in detail certain illustrative features of the one or more aspects. These features are indicative, however, of but a few of the various ways in which the principles of various aspects may be employed, and this description is intended to include all such aspects and their equivalents.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The disclosed aspects will hereinafter be described in conjunction with the appended drawings, provided to illustrate and not to limit the disclosed aspects, wherein like designations denote like elements, and in which:

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates an example of a wireless communication system, in accordance with various aspects of the present disclosure;

(3) FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating an example of disaggregated base station architecture, in accordance with various aspects of the present disclosure;

(4) FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating an example of a user equipment (UE), in accordance with various aspects of the present disclosure;

(5) FIG. 4 is a block diagram illustrating an example of a base station, in accordance with various aspects of the present disclosure;

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates a flow chart of an example of a method for securing physical layer communications using a secret key based on estimated path information, in accordance with aspects described herein;

(7) FIG. 6 illustrates a flow chart of an example of a method for securing physical layer communications using a secret key based on received path information, in accordance with aspects described herein;

(8) FIG. 7 illustrates an example of a wireless communication system, in accordance with aspects described herein;

(9) FIG. 8 illustrates a flow chart of an example of a method for authenticating physical layer

communications based on estimated path information, in accordance with aspects described herein; (10) FIG. 9 illustrates a flow chart of an example of a method for including information for authenticating physical layer communications based on received path information, in accordance with aspects described herein; and (11) FIG. 10 is a block diagram illustrating an example of a multiple-input multiple-output (MIMO) communication system including a base station and a UE, in accordance with various aspects of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(12) Various aspects are now described with reference to the drawings. In the following description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of one or more aspects. It may be evident, however, that such aspect(s) may be practiced without these specific details.

(13) The described features generally relate to securing wireless communications at the physical (PHY) layer based on path information. In some wireless communication technologies, such as fifth generation (5G) new radio (NR), some channels may not be secured, and some receivers may not have mechanisms for upper layer security, such as reconfigurable intelligent surfaces (RISs) controller, passive Internet-of-things (IoT) controller, etc. Secure communications can be important in wireless communication systems, however. Aspects described herein provide for securing communications at the PHY layer, which may include generating secret keys for encoding and decoding communications, or authenticating communications as coming from an intended source, based on the path information. According, the communications can be secured regardless of whether a RIS, passive IoT device (e.g., radio frequency identification (RFID) tag), etc. is involved in facilitate the communications between a transmitting and receiving device.

(14) For example, the path information may include a distance estimation based on signaling communicated between a transmitting and receiving device, a time-of-arrival (ToA) estimation based on signaling communicated between the transmitting and receiving device, a pathloss estimation based on signaling communicated between the transmitting and receiving device, an angle-of-arrival (AoA) estimation based on signaling communicated between the transmitting and receiving device, etc. In an example, one or more of these values can be estimated for multiple reference signals. The values for a pattern of reference signals can be used to generate a secret key for encoding and/or decoding wireless communications between the transmitting and receiving device. In another example, a transmitting device can send a communication to the receiving device, and the communication can indicate path information for the path over which the communication is sent. The receiving device, in this example, can authenticate the communication based on comparing the indicated path information to the path information of the path over which the communication is received.

(15) Using physical layer path information, which is already being estimated and/or communicated between the devices, can provide a low overhead mechanism for securing and/or authenticating wireless communications between a transmitting and receiving device. Securing and authenticating communications can protect data being communicated between the devices from being intercepted, can protect the devices from unwanted or malicious communications between received or processed by upper layers, etc. This can improve the quality of communications between the devices, which can accordingly improve user experience when using the UE.

(16) The described features will be presented in more detail below with reference to FIGS. 1-9.

(17) As used in this application, the terms “component,” “module,” “system” and the like are intended to include a computer-related entity, such as but not limited to hardware, firmware, a combination of hardware and software, software, or software in execution. For example, a component may be, but is not limited to being, a process running on a processor, a processor, an object, an executable, a thread of execution, a program, and/or a computer. By way of illustration, both an application running on a computing device and the computing device can be a component.

One or more components can reside within a process and/or thread of execution and a component can be localized on one computer and/or distributed between two or more computers. In addition, these components can execute from various computer readable media having various data structures stored thereon. The components can communicate by way of local and/or remote processes such as in accordance with a signal having one or more data packets, such as data from one component interacting with another component in a local system, distributed system, and/or across a network such as the Internet with other systems by way of the signal.

(18) Techniques described herein may be used for various wireless communication systems such as CDMA, TDMA, FDMA, OFDMA, SC-FDMA, and other systems. The terms “system” and “network” may often be used interchangeably. A CDMA system may implement a radio technology such as CDMA2000, Universal Terrestrial Radio Access (UTRA), etc. CDMA2000 covers IS-2000, IS-95, and IS-856 standards. IS-2000 Releases 0 and A are commonly referred to as CDMA2000 1×, 1×, etc. IS-856 (TIA-856) is commonly referred to as CDMA2000 1×EV-DO, High Rate Packet Data (HRPD), etc. UTRA includes Wideband CDMA (WCDMA) and other variants of CDMA. A TDMA system may implement a radio technology such as Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM). An OFDMA system may implement a radio technology such as Ultra Mobile Broadband (UMB), Evolved UTRA (E-UTRA), IEEE 802.11 (Wi-Fi), IEEE 802.16 (WiMAX), IEEE 802.20, Flash-OFDM™, etc. UTRA and E-UTRA are part of Universal Mobile Telecommunication System (UMTS). 3GPP Long Term Evolution (LTE) and LTE-Advanced (LTE-A) are new releases of UMTS that use E-UTRA. UTRA, E-UTRA, UMTS, LTE, LTE-A, and GSM are described in documents from an organization named “3rd Generation Partnership Project” (3GPP). CDMA2000 and UMB are described in documents from an organization named “3rd Generation Partnership Project 2” (3GPP2). The techniques described herein may be used for the systems and radio technologies mentioned above as well as other systems and radio technologies, including cellular (e.g., LTE) communications over a shared radio frequency spectrum band. The description below, however, describes an LTE/LTE-A system for purposes of example, and LTE terminology is used in much of the description below, although the techniques are applicable beyond LTE/LTE-A applications (e.g., to fifth generation (5G) new radio (NR) networks or other next generation communication systems).

(19) The following description provides examples, and is not limiting of the scope, applicability, or examples set forth in the claims. Changes may be made in the function and arrangement of elements discussed without departing from the scope of the disclosure. Various examples may omit, substitute, or add various procedures or components as appropriate. For instance, the methods described may be performed in an order different from that described, and various steps may be added, omitted, or combined. Also, features described with respect to some examples may be combined in other examples.

(20) Various aspects or features will be presented in terms of systems that can include a number of devices, components, modules, and the like. It is to be understood and appreciated that the various systems can include additional devices, components, modules, etc. and/or may not include all of the devices, components, modules etc. discussed in connection with the figures. A combination of these approaches can also be used.

(21) FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating an example of a wireless communications system and an access network **100**. The wireless communications system (also referred to as a wireless wide area network (WWAN)) can include network entities **102**, also referred to herein as base stations **102**, including one or more components of a disaggregated base station, UEs **104**, an Evolved Packet Core (EPC) **160**, and/or a 5G Core (5GC) **190**. The base stations **102** may include macro cells (high power cellular base station) and/or small cells (low power cellular base station). The macro cells can include base stations. The small cells can include femtocells, picocells, and microcells. In an example, the base stations **102** may also include gNBs **180**, as described further herein. In one example, some nodes of the wireless communication system may have a modem **240** and UE

communicating component **342** for securing physical layer communications based on path information, in accordance with aspects described herein. In addition, some nodes may have a modem **340** and BS communicating component **442** for securing physical layer communications, in accordance with aspects described herein. Though a UE **104** is shown as having the modem **240** and UE communicating component **342** and a base station **102**/gNB **180** is shown as having the modem **340** and BS communicating component **442**, this is one illustrative example, and substantially any node or type of node may include a modem **240** and UE communicating component **342** and/or a modem **340** and BS communicating component **442** for providing corresponding functionalities described herein. Indeed, in one example, another UE may include the BS communicating component **442** for securing sidelink communications with the UE **104**.

(22) The base stations **102** configured for 4G LTE (which can collectively be referred to as Evolved Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS) Terrestrial Radio Access Network (E-UTRAN)) may interface with the EPC **160** through backhaul links **132** (e.g., using an S1 interface). The base stations **102** configured for 5G NR (which can collectively be referred to as Next Generation RAN (NG-RAN)) may interface with 5GC **190** through backhaul links **184**. In addition to other functions, the base stations **102** may perform one or more of the following functions: transfer of user data, radio channel ciphering and deciphering, integrity protection, header compression, mobility control functions (e.g., handover, dual connectivity), inter-cell interference coordination, connection setup and release, load balancing, distribution for non-access stratum (NAS) messages, NAS node selection, synchronization, radio access network (RAN) sharing, multimedia broadcast multicast service (MBMS), subscriber and equipment trace, RAN information management (RIM), paging, positioning, and delivery of warning messages. The base stations **102** may communicate directly or indirectly (e.g., through the EPC **160** or 5GC **190**) with each other over backhaul links **134** (e.g., using an X2 interface). The backhaul links **134** may be wired or wireless.

(23) The base stations **102** may wirelessly communicate with one or more UEs **104**. Each of the base stations **102** may provide communication coverage for a respective geographic coverage area **110**. There may be overlapping geographic coverage areas **110**. For example, the small cell **102'** may have a coverage area **110'** that overlaps the coverage area **110** of one or more macro base stations **102**. A network that includes both small cell and macro cells may be referred to as a heterogeneous network. A heterogeneous network may also include Home Evolved Node Bs (eNBs) (HeNBs), which may provide service to a restricted group, which can be referred to as a closed subscriber group (CSG). The communication links **120** between the base stations **102** and the UEs **104** may include uplink (UL) (also referred to as reverse link) transmissions from a UE **104** to a base station **102** and/or downlink (DL) (also referred to as forward link) transmissions from a base station **102** to a UE **104**. The communication links **120** may use multiple-input and multiple-output (MIMO) antenna technology, including spatial multiplexing, beamforming, and/or transmit diversity. The communication links may be through one or more carriers. The base stations **102**/UEs **104** may use spectrum up to Y MHz (e.g., 10, 15, 20, 100, 400, etc. MHz) bandwidth per carrier allocated in a carrier aggregation of up to a total of Yx MHz (e.g., for x component carriers) used for transmission in the DL and/or the UL direction. The carriers may or may not be adjacent to each other. Allocation of carriers may be asymmetric with respect to DL and UL (e.g., more or less carriers may be allocated for DL than for UL). The component carriers may include a primary component carrier and one or more secondary component carriers. A primary component carrier may be referred to as a primary cell (PCell) and a secondary component carrier may be referred to as a secondary cell (SCell).

(24) In another example, certain UEs **104** may communicate with each other using device-to-device (D2D) communication link **158**. The D2D communication link **158** may use the DL/UL WWAN spectrum. The D2D communication link **158** may use one or more sidelink channels, such as a physical sidelink broadcast channel (PSBCH), a physical sidelink discovery channel (PSDCH), a

physical sidelink shared channel (PSSCH), and a physical sidelink control channel (PSCCH). D2D communication may be through a variety of wireless D2D communications systems, such as for example, FlashLinQ, WiMedia, Bluetooth, ZigBee, Wi-Fi based on the IEEE 802.11 standard, LTE, or NR.

(25) The wireless communications system may further include a Wi-Fi access point (AP) **150** in communication with Wi-Fi stations (STAs) **152** via communication links **154** in a 5 GHz unlicensed frequency spectrum. When communicating in an unlicensed frequency spectrum, the STAs **152**/AP **150** may perform a clear channel assessment (CCA) prior to communicating in order to determine whether the channel is available.

(26) The small cell **102'** may operate in a licensed and/or an unlicensed frequency spectrum. When operating in an unlicensed frequency spectrum, the small cell **102'** may employ NR and use the same 5 GHz unlicensed frequency spectrum as used by the Wi-Fi AP **150**. The small cell **102'**, employing NR in an unlicensed frequency spectrum, may boost coverage to and/or increase capacity of the access network.

(27) A base station **102**, whether a small cell **102'** or a large cell (e.g., macro base station), may include an eNB, gNodeB (gNB), or other type of base station. Some base stations, such as gNB **180** may operate in a traditional sub 6 GHz spectrum, in millimeter wave (mmW) frequencies, and/or near mmW frequencies in communication with the UE **104**. When the gNB **180** operates in mmW or near mmW frequencies, the gNB **180** may be referred to as an mmW base station. Extremely high frequency (EHF) is part of the RF in the electromagnetic spectrum. EHF has a range of 30 GHz to 300 GHz and a wavelength between 1 millimeter and 10 millimeters. Radio waves in the band may be referred to as a millimeter wave. Near mmW may extend down to a frequency of 3 GHz with a wavelength of 100 millimeters. The super high frequency (SHF) band extends between 3 GHz and 30 GHz, also referred to as centimeter wave. Communications using the mmW/near mmW radio frequency band has extremely high path loss and a short range. The mmW base station **180** may utilize beamforming **182** with the UE **104** to compensate for the extremely high path loss and short range. A base station **102** referred to herein can include a gNB **180**.

(28) The EPC **160** may include a Mobility Management Entity (MME) **162**, other MMEs **164**, a Serving Gateway **166**, a Multimedia Broadcast Multicast Service (MBMS) Gateway **168**, a Broadcast Multicast Service Center (BM-SC) **170**, and a Packet Data Network (PDN) Gateway **172**. The MME **162** may be in communication with a Home Subscriber Server (HSS) **174**. The MME **162** is the control node that processes the signaling between the UEs **104** and the EPC **160**. Generally, the MME **162** provides bearer and connection management. All user Internet protocol (IP) packets are transferred through the Serving Gateway **166**, which itself is connected to the PDN Gateway **172**. The PDN Gateway **172** provides UE IP address allocation as well as other functions. The PDN Gateway **172** and the BM-SC **170** are connected to the IP Services **176**. The IP Services **176** may include the Internet, an intranet, an IP Multimedia Subsystem (IMS), a PS Streaming Service, and/or other IP services. The BM-SC **170** may provide functions for MBMS user service provisioning and delivery. The BM-SC **170** may serve as an entry point for content provider MBMS transmission, may be used to authorize and initiate MBMS Bearer Services within a public land mobile network (PLMN), and may be used to schedule MBMS transmissions. The MBMS Gateway **168** may be used to distribute MBMS traffic to the base stations **102** belonging to a Multicast Broadcast Single Frequency Network (MBSFN) area broadcasting a particular service, and may be responsible for session management (start/stop) and for collecting eMBMS related charging information.

(29) The 5GC **190** may include a Access and Mobility Management Function (AMF) **192**, other AMFs **193**, a Session Management Function (SMF) **194**, and a User Plane Function (UPF) **195**. The AMF **192** may be in communication with a Unified Data Management (UDM) **196**. The AMF **192** can be a control node that processes the signaling between the UEs **104** and the 5GC **190**. Generally, the AMF **192** can provide QoS flow and session management. User Internet protocol

(IP) packets (e.g., from one or more UEs **104**) can be transferred through the UPF **195**. The UPF **195** can provide UE IP address allocation for one or more UEs, as well as other functions. The UPF **195** is connected to the IP Services **197**. The IP Services **197** may include the Internet, an intranet, an IP Multimedia Subsystem (IMS), a PS Streaming Service, and/or other IP services.

(30) The network entity or base station may also be referred to as a gNB, Node B, evolved Node B (eNB), an access point, a base transceiver station, a radio base station, a radio transceiver, a transceiver function, a basic service set (BSS), an extended service set (ESS), a transmit reception point (TRP), or some other suitable terminology. The base station **102** provides an access point to the EPC **160** or 5GC **190** for a UE **104**. Examples of UEs **104** include a cellular phone, a smart phone, a session initiation protocol (SIP) phone, a laptop, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a satellite radio, a global positioning system, a multimedia device, a video device, a digital audio player (e.g., MP3 player), a camera, a game console, a tablet, a smart device, a wearable device, a vehicle, an electric meter, a gas pump, a large or small kitchen appliance, a healthcare device, an implant, a sensor/actuator, a display, or any other similar functioning device. Some of the UEs **104** may be referred to as IoT devices (e.g., parking meter, gas pump, toaster, vehicles, heart monitor, etc.). IoT UEs may include machine type communication (MTC)/enhanced MTC (eMTC, also referred to as category (CAT)-M, Cat M1) UEs, NB-IoT (also referred to as CAT NB1) UEs, as well as other types of UEs. In the present disclosure, eMTC and NB-IoT may refer to future technologies that may evolve from or may be based on these technologies. For example, eMTC may include FeMTC (further eMTC), eFeMTC (enhanced further eMTC), mMTC (massive MTC), etc., and NB-IoT may include eNB-IoT (enhanced NB-IoT), FeNB-IoT (further enhanced NB-IoT), etc. The UE **104** may also be referred to as a station, a mobile station, a subscriber station, a mobile unit, a subscriber unit, a wireless unit, a remote unit, a mobile device, a wireless device, a wireless communications device, a remote device, a mobile subscriber station, an access terminal, a mobile terminal, a wireless terminal, a remote terminal, a handset, a user agent, a mobile client, a client, or some other suitable terminology.

(31) In an example, in a 5G NR system, or network, a network node, a network entity, a mobility element of a network, a radio access network (RAN) node, a core network node, a network element, or a network equipment, such as a base station (BS), or one or more units (or one or more components) performing base station functionality, may be implemented in an aggregated or disaggregated architecture. For example, a BS (such as a Node B (NB), evolved NB (eNB), NR BS, 5G NB, access point (AP), a transmit receive point (TRP), or a cell, etc.), including base station **102** described above and further herein, may be implemented as an aggregated base station (also known as a standalone BS or a monolithic BS) or a disaggregated base station.

(32) An aggregated base station may be configured to utilize a radio protocol stack that is physically or logically integrated within a single RAN node. A disaggregated base station may be configured to utilize a protocol stack that is physically or logically distributed among two or more units (such as one or more central or centralized units (CUs), one or more distributed units (DUs), or one or more radio units (RUs)). In some aspects, a CU may be implemented within a RAN node, and one or more DUs may be co-located with the CU, or alternatively, may be geographically or virtually distributed throughout one or multiple other RAN nodes. The DUs may be implemented to communicate with one or more RUs. Each of the CU, DU and RU also can be implemented as virtual units, i.e., a virtual central unit (VCU), a virtual distributed unit (VDU), or a virtual radio unit (VRU).

(33) Base station-type operation or network design may consider aggregation characteristics of base station functionality. For example, disaggregated base stations may be utilized in an integrated access backhaul (IAB) network, an open radio access network (O-RAN (such as the network configuration sponsored by the O-RAN Alliance)), or a virtualized radio access network (vRAN, also known as a cloud radio access network (C-RAN)). Disaggregation may include distributing functionality across two or more units at various physical locations, as well as virtually distributing

functionality for at least one unit, which can enable flexibility in network design. The various units of the disaggregated base station, or disaggregated RAN architecture, can be configured for wired or wireless communication with at least one other unit.

(34) In an example, UE communicating component **342** can receive signals from the base station **102** (or another UE) over multiple paths, and can estimate path information for each of the signals (e.g., distance, pathloss, received power, reference signal received power (RSRP), reference signal received quality (RSRQ), amplitude or phase of strongest time-domain channel tap, amplitude or phase of average time-domain channel tap, number of channel taps greater than a threshold (which can be a layer 1 (L1)/layer 2(L2)/layer 3 (L3) configurable threshold), signal-to-noise-plus-interference ratio (SINR) of specific taps or averaged across all taps or a subset of taps (which may be selected by an L1/L2/L3 configurable threshold), ToA, AoA, etc.). UE communicating component **342** can communicate the path information to the base station **102** (or another UE), and can use the path information to generate a secret key for encoding or decoding communications with the base station **102** (or another UE), to authenticate communications from the base station **102** (or another UE), etc., as described further herein. In an example, the base station **102** (or another UE) can include a BS communicating component **442** that can receive the path information from UE communicating component **342** of UE **104**, and can use this information for similarly encoding or decoding communications with the UE **104**, authenticating communications transmitted to the UE **104**, etc.

(35) FIG. 2 shows a diagram illustrating an example of disaggregated base station **200** architecture, wherein, as noted above, one or more components of which may be included when the terms network entity or a base station are used herein. The disaggregated base station **200** architecture may include one or more central units (CUs) **210** that can communicate directly with a core network **220** via a backhaul link, or indirectly with the core network **220** through one or more disaggregated base station units (such as a Near-Real Time (Near-RT) RAN Intelligent Controller (RIC) **225** via an E2 link, or a Non-Real Time (Non-RT) RIC **215** associated with a Service Management and Orchestration (SMO) Framework **205**, or both). A CU **210** may communicate with one or more distributed units (DUs) **230** via respective midhaul links, such as an F1 interface. The DUs **230** may communicate with one or more radio units (RUs) **240** via respective fronthaul links. The RUs **240** may communicate with respective UEs **104** via one or more radio frequency (RF) access links. In some implementations, the UE **104** may be simultaneously served by multiple RUs **240**.

(36) Each of the units, e.g., the CUs **210**, the DUs **230**, the RUs **240**, as well as the Near-RT RICs **225**, the Non-RT RICs **215** and the SMO Framework **205**, may include one or more interfaces or be coupled to one or more interfaces configured to receive or transmit signals, data, or information (collectively, signals) via a wired or wireless transmission medium. Each of the units, or an associated processor or controller providing instructions to the communication interfaces of the units, can be configured to communicate with one or more of the other units via the transmission medium. For example, the units can include a wired interface configured to receive or transmit signals over a wired transmission medium to one or more of the other units. Additionally, the units can include a wireless interface, which may include a receiver, a transmitter or transceiver (such as a radio frequency (RF) transceiver), configured to receive or transmit signals, or both, over a wireless transmission medium to one or more of the other units.

(37) In some aspects, the CU **210** may host one or more higher layer control functions. Such control functions can include radio resource control (RRC), packet data convergence protocol (PDCP), service data adaptation protocol (SDAP), or the like. Each control function can be implemented with an interface configured to communicate signals with other control functions hosted by the CU **210**. The CU **210** may be configured to handle user plane functionality (i.e., Central Unit-User Plane (CU-UP)), control plane functionality (i.e., Central Unit-Control Plane (CU-CP)), or a combination thereof. In some implementations, the CU **210** can be logically split

into one or more CU-UP units and one or more CU-CP units. The CU-UP unit can communicate bidirectionally with the CU-CP unit via an interface, such as the E1 interface when implemented in an O-RAN configuration. The CU **210** can be implemented to communicate with the DU **230**, as necessary, for network control and signaling.

(38) The DU **230** may correspond to a logical unit that includes one or more base station functions to control the operation of one or more RUs **240**. In some aspects, the DU **230** may host one or more of a radio link control (RLC) layer, a medium access control (MAC) layer, and one or more high physical (PHY) layers (such as modules for forward error correction (FEC) encoding and decoding, scrambling, modulation and demodulation, or the like) depending, at least in part, on a functional split, such as those defined by the third Generation Partnership Project (3GPP). In some aspects, the DU **230** may further host one or more low PHY layers. Each layer (or module) can be implemented with an interface configured to communicate signals with other layers (and modules) hosted by the DU **230**, or with the control functions hosted by the CU **210**.

(39) Lower-layer functionality can be implemented by one or more RUs **240**. In some deployments, an RU **240**, controlled by a DU **230**, may correspond to a logical node that hosts RF processing functions, or low-PHY layer functions (such as performing fast Fourier transform (FFT), inverse FFT (iFFT), digital beamforming, physical random access channel (PRACH) extraction and filtering, or the like), or both, based at least in part on the functional split, such as a lower layer functional split. In such an architecture, the RU(s) **240** can be implemented to handle over the air (OTA) communication with one or more UEs **104**. In some implementations, real-time and non-real-time aspects of control and user plane communication with the RU(s) **240** can be controlled by the corresponding DU **230**. In some scenarios, this configuration can enable the DU(s) **230** and the CU **210** to be implemented in a cloud-based RAN architecture, such as a vRAN architecture.

(40) The SMO Framework **205** may be configured to support RAN deployment and provisioning of non-virtualized and virtualized network elements. For non-virtualized network elements, the SMO Framework **205** may be configured to support the deployment of dedicated physical resources for RAN coverage requirements which may be managed via an operations and maintenance interface (such as an O1 interface). For virtualized network elements, the SMO Framework **205** may be configured to interact with a cloud computing platform (such as an open cloud (O-Cloud) **290**) to perform network element life cycle management (such as to instantiate virtualized network elements) via a cloud computing platform interface (such as an O2 interface). Such virtualized network elements can include, but are not limited to, CUs **210**, DUs **230**, RUs **240** and Near-RT RICs **225**. In some implementations, the SMO Framework **205** can communicate with a hardware aspect of a 4G RAN, such as an open eNB (O-eNB) **211**, via an O1 interface. Additionally, in some implementations, the SMO Framework **205** can communicate directly with one or more RUs **240** via an O1 interface. The SMO Framework **205** also may include a Non-RT RIC **215** configured to support functionality of the SMO Framework **205**.

(41) The Non-RT RIC **215** may be configured to include a logical function that enables non-real-time control and optimization of RAN elements and resources, Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning (AI/ML) workflows including model training and updates, or policy-based guidance of applications/features in the Near-RT RIC **225**. The Non-RT RIC **215** may be coupled to or communicate with (such as via an A1 interface) the Near-RT RIC **225**. The Near-RT RIC **225** may be configured to include a logical function that enables near-real-time control and optimization of RAN elements and resources via data collection and actions over an interface (such as via an E2 interface) connecting one or more CUs **210**, one or more DUs **230**, or both, as well as an O-eNB, with the Near-RT RIC **225**.

(42) In some implementations, to generate AI/ML models to be deployed in the Near-RT RIC **225**, the Non-RT RIC **215** may receive parameters or external enrichment information from external servers. Such information may be utilized by the Near-RT RIC **225** and may be received at the SMO Framework **205** or the Non-RT RIC **215** from non-network data sources or from network

functions. In some examples, the Non-RT RIC **215** or the Near-RT RIC **225** may be configured to tune RAN behavior or performance. For example, the Non-RT RIC **215** may monitor long-term trends and patterns for performance and employ AI/ML models to perform corrective actions through the SMO Framework **205** (such as reconfiguration via O1) or via creation of RAN management policies (such as A1 policies).

(43) Turning now to FIGS. **3-10**, aspects are depicted with reference to one or more components and one or more methods that may perform the actions or operations described herein, where aspects in dashed line may be optional. Although the operations described below in FIGS. **5, 6, 8, and 9** are presented in a particular order and/or as being performed by an example component, it should be understood that the ordering of the actions and the components performing the actions may be varied, depending on the implementation. Moreover, it should be understood that the following actions, functions, and/or described components may be performed by a specially programmed processor, a processor executing specially programmed software or computer-readable media, or by any other combination of a hardware component and/or a software component capable of performing the described actions or functions.

(44) Referring to FIG. **3**, one example of an implementation of UE **104** may include a variety of components, some of which have already been described above and are described further herein, including components such as one or more processors **312** and memory **316** and transceiver **302** in communication via one or more buses **344**, which may operate in conjunction with modem **340** and/or UE communicating component **342** for securing communications at a PHY layer based on path information, in accordance with aspects described herein.

(45) In an aspect, the one or more processors **312** can include a modem **340** and/or can be part of the modem **340** that uses one or more modem processors. Thus, the various functions related to UE communicating component **342** may be included in modem **340** and/or processors **312** and, in an aspect, can be executed by a single processor, while in other aspects, different ones of the functions may be executed by a combination of two or more different processors. For example, in an aspect, the one or more processors **312** may include any one or any combination of a modem processor, or a baseband processor, or a digital signal processor, or a transmit processor, or a receiver processor, or a transceiver processor associated with transceiver **302**. In other aspects, some of the features of the one or more processors **312** and/or modem **340** associated with UE communicating component **342** may be performed by transceiver **302**.

(46) Also, memory **316** may be configured to store data used herein and/or local versions of applications **375** or UE communicating component **342** and/or one or more of its subcomponents being executed by at least one processor **312**. Memory **316** can include any type of computer-readable medium usable by a computer or at least one processor **312**, such as random access memory (RAM), read only memory (ROM), tapes, magnetic discs, optical discs, volatile memory, non-volatile memory, and any combination thereof. In an aspect, for example, memory **316** may be a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium that stores one or more computer-executable codes defining UE communicating component **342** and/or one or more of its subcomponents, and/or data associated therewith, when UE **104** is operating at least one processor **312** to execute UE communicating component **342** and/or one or more of its subcomponents.

(47) Transceiver **302** may include at least one receiver **306** and at least one transmitter **308**. Receiver **306** may include hardware, firmware, and/or software code executable by a processor for receiving data, the code comprising instructions and being stored in a memory (e.g., computer-readable medium). Receiver **306** may be, for example, a radio frequency (RF) receiver. In an aspect, receiver **306** may receive signals transmitted by at least one base station **102** or another UE **104**. Additionally, receiver **306** may process such received signals, and also may obtain measurements of the signals, such as, but not limited to, Ec/Io, signal-to-noise ratio (SNR), reference signal received power (RSRP), received signal strength indicator (RSSI), etc. Transmitter **308** may include hardware, firmware, and/or software code executable by a processor for

transmitting data, the code comprising instructions and being stored in a memory (e.g., computer-readable medium). A suitable example of transmitter **308** may including, but is not limited to, an RF transmitter.

(48) Moreover, in an aspect, UE **104** may include RF front end **388**, which may operate in communication with one or more antennas **365** and transceiver **302** for receiving and transmitting radio transmissions, for example, wireless communications transmitted by at least one base station **102** or another UE **104**, or wireless transmissions transmitted by UE **104**. RF front end **388** may be connected to one or more antennas **365** and can include one or more low-noise amplifiers (LNAs) **390**, one or more switches **392**, one or more power amplifiers (PAs) **398**, and one or more filters **396** for transmitting and receiving RF signals.

(49) In an aspect, LNA **390** can amplify a received signal at a desired output level. In an aspect, each LNA **390** may have a specified minimum and maximum gain values. In an aspect, RF front end **388** may use one or more switches **392** to select a particular LNA **390** and its specified gain value based on a desired gain value for a particular application.

(50) Further, for example, one or more PA(s) **398** may be used by RF front end **388** to amplify a signal for an RF output at a desired output power level. In an aspect, each PA **398** may have specified minimum and maximum gain values. In an aspect, RF front end **388** may use one or more switches **392** to select a particular PA **398** and its specified gain value based on a desired gain value for a particular application.

(51) Also, for example, one or more filters **396** can be used by RF front end **388** to filter a received signal to obtain an input RF signal. Similarly, in an aspect, for example, a respective filter **396** can be used to filter an output from a respective PA **398** to produce an output signal for transmission. In an aspect, each filter **396** can be connected to a specific LNA **390** and/or PA **398**. In an aspect, RF front end **388** can use one or more switches **392** to select a transmit or receive path using a specified filter **396**, LNA **390**, and/or PA **398**, based on a configuration as specified by transceiver **302** and/or processor **312**.

(52) As such, transceiver **302** may be configured to transmit and receive wireless signals through one or more antennas **365** via RF front end **388**. In an aspect, transceiver may be tuned to operate at specified frequencies such that UE **104** can communicate with, for example, one or more base stations **102** or one or more cells associated with one or more base stations **102**, or with one or more other UEs **104**. In an aspect, for example, modem **340** can configure transceiver **302** to operate at a specified frequency and power level based on the UE configuration of the UE **104** and the communication protocol used by modem **340**.

(53) In an aspect, modem **340** can be a multiband-multimode modem, which can process digital data and communicate with transceiver **302** such that the digital data is sent and received using transceiver **302**. In an aspect, modem **340** can be multiband and be configured to support multiple frequency bands for a specific communications protocol. In an aspect, modem **340** can be multimode and be configured to support multiple operating networks and communications protocols. In an aspect, modem **340** can control one or more components of UE **104** (e.g., RF front end **388**, transceiver **302**) to enable transmission and/or reception of signals from the network based on a specified modem configuration. In an aspect, the modem configuration can be based on the mode of the modem and the frequency band in use. In another aspect, the modem configuration can be based on UE configuration information associated with UE **104** as provided by the network during cell selection and/or cell reselection.

(54) In an aspect, UE communicating component **342** can optionally include a path information component **352** for estimating path information between the UE **104** and the base station **102** (or another UE), a securing component **354** for securing (e.g., encoding or decoding) communications at the PHY layer based on the path information, and/or an authenticating component **356** for authenticating communications received from the base station **102** (or another UE) based on the path information, in accordance with aspects described herein.

(55) In an aspect, the processor(s) **312** may correspond to one or more of the processors described in connection with the UE in FIG. **10**. Similarly, the memory **316** may correspond to the memory described in connection with the UE in FIG. **10**.

(56) Referring to FIG. **4**, one example of an implementation of base station **102** (e.g., a base station **102** and/or gNB **180**, a monolithic base station, one or more components of a disaggregated base station, etc., as described above) may include a variety of components, some of which have already been described above, but including components such as one or more processors **412** and memory **416** and transceiver **402** in communication via one or more buses **444**, which may operate in conjunction with modem **440** and BS communicating component **442** for securing communications at a PHY layer based on path information, in accordance with aspects described herein. In another example, as described herein, BS communicating component **442** can be implemented in a UE for sidelink communications with another UE **104**. In one example, a UE can have both the UE communicating component **342** and the BS communicating component **442** for securing and/or authenticating communications with another UE **104**.

(57) The transceiver **402**, receiver **406**, transmitter **408**, one or more processors **412**, memory **416**, applications **475**, buses **444**, RF front end **488**, LNAs **490**, switches **492**, filters **496**, PAs **498**, and one or more antennas **465** may be the same as or similar to the corresponding components of UE **104**, as described above, but configured or otherwise programmed for base station operations as opposed to UE operations.

(58) In an aspect, BS communicating component **442** can optionally include a path information processing component **452** for receiving and/or processing path information received from a UE, a securing component **454** for securing (e.g., encoding or decoding) communications at the PHY layer based on the path information, and/or an authentication information component **456** for including authentication information in communications transmitted to the UE, in accordance with aspects described herein.

(59) In an aspect, the processor(s) **412** may correspond to one or more of the processors described in connection with the base station in FIG. **10**. Similarly, the memory **416** may correspond to the memory described in connection with the base station in FIG. **10**.

(60) FIG. **5** illustrates a flow chart of an example of a method **500** for securing physical layer communications using a secret key based on estimated path information, in accordance with aspects described herein. FIG. **6** illustrates a flow chart of an example of a method **600** for securing physical layer communications using a secret key based on received path information, in accordance with aspects described herein. In an example, a UE **104** can perform the functions described in method **500** using one or more of the components described in FIGS. **1** and **3**, and a base station **102** or another UE (e.g., in sidelink communications with UE **104**) can perform the functions described in method **600** using one or more of the components described in FIGS. **1** and **4**. Methods **500** and **600** are described in conjunction with one another for ease of explanation. These methods, however, are not required to be performed in conjunction with one another, and different devices can be configured to perform the methods without requiring the other device.

(61) In method **600**, at Block **602**, multiple reference signals can be transmitted, to a receiving device, over multiple different paths. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can transmit, to the receiving device, multiple reference signals over multiple different paths. For example, the base station **102** (or other UE in sidelink communications) can transmit to the UE **104** using multiple different paths, which may include a direct path to the UE **104**, a path through one or more forwarding components, such as a RIS, passive IoT device such as a RFID tag, a relay device (e.g., an amplify-and-forward (AF) half-duplex (HD) or full-duplex (FD) relay device), etc. An example is shown in FIG. **7**.

(62) FIG. **7** illustrates an example of a wireless communication system **700** including a UE **104-a** and another UE **104-b**, though one or more of the UEs may be a base station **102** or other device, as

described herein. Wireless communication includes a forwarding component **702** that can forward signal received from one UE **104-a** to another UE **104-b** (or other device). For example, forwarding component **702** may include one or more of a RIS, passive IoT device, such as a RFID tag, a relay device (e.g., an AF FD relay device), etc. In this regard, for example, UE **104-a** can transmit reference signals and/or other signals to UE **104-b** using Path **1**, which may be based on a first beam **704** and which traverses the forwarding component **702**. In this example, UE **104-a** can also transmit reference signals and/or other signals to UE **104-b** using Path **2**, which may be based on a second beam **706** and may not traverse a forwarding component, or may otherwise be directly between the UEs **104-a** and **104-b**. In general, for example, UE **104-b** can use the information of the strongest path detected by the UE **104-b** to determine the path information (e.g., distance, pathloss, received power, RSRP, RSRQ, amplitude or phase of strongest time-domain channel tap, amplitude or phase of average time-domain channel tap, number of channel taps greater than an L1/L2/L3 configurable threshold, signal-to-noise-plus-interference ratio of specific taps or averaged across all taps or a subset of taps selected by an L1/L2/L3 configurable threshold, ToA, AoA) used for communication between the UEs **104-a** and **104-b**.

(63) In method **500**, optionally at Block **502**, multiple reference signals can be received, from a transmitting device, over multiple different paths. In an aspect, UE communicating component **342**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, etc., can receive, from the transmitting device (e.g., a base station **102** or another UE), the multiple reference signals over the multiple different paths. For example, as shown in FIG. **7**, UE communicating component **342** can receive the multiple reference signals over a direct path, a path that can traverse a forwarding component, etc. The paths can have distinct path characteristics (and thus estimated path information). For example, the potential path information could be $\{P_1, P_2, \dots, P_N\}$ for N Paths/Routes, where each path is associated with some information such as distances, $\{d_1, d_2, \dots, d_N\}$, and AoAs, $\{\Phi_1, \Phi_2, \dots, \Phi_N\}$. In an example, Path/Route Information can be used to determine a secret key (SK) that the transmitting device wants the receiving device to use while communicating with it. Thus, in an example, BS communicating component **442** can send, and/or UE communicating component **342** can receive, a set of time division multiplexed (TDMed) reference signals (or TDMed/frequency division multiplexed (FDMed) where each subband is beamformed to a certain direction and reflected by a certain forwarding component). Based on a desired SK, the transmitting device can send various RSs to result on the desired path information being used to generate the SK, as described further herein.

(64) In method **500**, at Block **504**, path information for each of multiple reference signals received over one of multiple different paths from a transmitting device can be generated. In an aspect, path information component **352**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can generate the path information for each of multiple reference signals received over one of multiple different paths from the transmitting device. For example, path information component **352** can generate or estimate a distance metric between the UE **104** and transmitting device, or the UE **104** and forwarding component, based on a signal strength or quality measurement of each of the multiple reference signals. In another example, path information component **352** can generate or estimate a time-of-arrival of each of the multiple reference signals. In another example, path information component **352** can generate or estimate a pathloss of each of the multiple reference signals (e.g., based at least in part on a difference between a signal transmission time indicated in the signals and a time at which the signals were received). In another example, path information component **352** can generate or estimate an angle-of-arrival of each of the multiple reference signals at an antenna or RF element of the UE **104**.

(65) In method **500**, optionally Block **506**, the path information generated for each of the multiple reference signals can be transmitted to the transmitting device. In an aspect, path information component **352**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE

communicating component **342**, etc., can transmit, to the transmitting device, the path information generated for each of the multiple reference signals. For example, path information component **352** can transmit the path information as part of feedback for the reference signals, based on which the transmitting device can determine one or more parameters for PHY layer communication with the UE **104**, such as a modulation and coding scheme (MCS), rank indicator (RI), precoding matrix indicator (PMI), etc. For example, the UE **104** as the receiving device can determine a set of (distinguishable) paths, can associate each path with an identifier (e.g., a reference signal identifier indicated by the reference signal can be used), and can send the path information (e.g., distance, pathloss, received power, RSRP, RSRQ, amplitude or phase of strongest time-domain channel tap, amplitude or phase of average time-domain channel tap, number of channel taps greater than an L1/L2/L3 configurable threshold, signal-to-noise-plus-interference ratio of specific taps or averaged across all taps or a subset of taps selected by an L1/L2/L3 configurable threshold, ToA, AoA), or just the identifiers of the best paths, to the transmitting device.

(66) In method **600**, optionally Block **604**, the path information generated for each of the multiple reference signals can be received from the receiving device. In an aspect, path information processing component **452**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, BS communicating component **442**, etc., can receive, from the receiving device, the path information generated for each of the multiple reference signals. For example, path information processing component **452** can receive the path information as part of feedback for the reference signals, based on which the UE **104** as the transmitting device can determine one or more parameters for PHY layer communication with the receiving device, such as a MCS, RI, PMI, etc. In one example, as described the path information may just include the identifiers of the best paths.

(67) In this example, the transmitting device and the receiving device can have the same set of path information for each of the reference signals, which may include the identifier of the reference signal of the best paths, the distance metric, ToA, pathloss, AoA, etc. In any case, the transmitting device and receiving device may use this information to (e.g., independently) generate a secret key for communications. In one example, the transmitting device can indicate a pattern for applying the path information to generate the secret key, which may include indicating an ordering of the path information for the reference signals to use in generating the secret key. For example, transmitting device may indicate the ordering by transmitting the reference signals in a certain order, and the receiving device (and transmitting device) can apply the path information for the reference signals according to an order by which the reference signals are transmitted/received.

(68) For example, in method **600**, optionally Block **606**, an indication of an order for applying the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals can be transmitted to the receiving device. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can transmit, to the receiving device, the indication of the order for applying the path information for the two or more of the multiple reference signals. For example, BS communicating component **442** can transmit the indication in explicit signaling or implicitly by transmitting the reference signals to the receiving device in a certain order.

(69) For example, in method **500**, optionally Block **508**, an indication of an order for applying the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals can be received from the transmitting device. In an aspect, UE communicating component **342**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, etc., can receive, from the transmitting device, the indication of the order for applying the path information for the two or more of the multiple reference signals. For example, UE communicating component **342** can receive the indication in explicit signaling or implicitly by receiving the reference signals from the transmitting device in a certain order, where the order can represent the order of combining or applying path information to generate the secret key.

(70) In this regard, for example, the transmitting device can send another indication (before or after

sending the reference signal) to use a certain/subset of path information of a subset of reference signals to generate the secret key. This can help in ordering how to use the path information observed by each reference signal. In one example, the transmitting device can send a subset of reference signals in a certain pattern to be used in generating the secret key.

(71) In method **500**, optionally Block **510**, the secret key can be generated based at least in part on applying a function of the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals. In an aspect, securing component **354**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can generate the secret key based at least in part on applying the function of the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals. In an example, securing component **354** can apply the function of path information using an order of path information indicated by the transmitting device, as described above. In addition, for example, securing component **354** can apply the function of path information using certain values that may be configured between the devices or otherwise known. As described, for example, securing component **354** can use at least one of values of the exact path information transmitted to the transmitting device, labels or identifiers (e.g., the reference signal identifiers), or a combination thereof to generate the secret key. In one example, the function can be a hash function using the path information values, such as a hash message authentication code (HMAC) function, which may use a secure hash algorithm (SHA), such as SHA256 based on 256 bits. In an example, such a function may have a signature similar to the following: HMAC-SHA256(key, timestamp, parameters).

(72) In an example, the transmitting device can try to instruct the receiving device to use a certain secret key by sending a set of reference signals, where each reference signal is sent using certain beams across all forwarding components, the transmitting device, and the receiving device (e.g., the receiving device can fix a beam). The receiving device can detect distances for the reference signal. In an specific example, the distances can be d_1 , d_4 , d_N , d_2 . The secret key can depend on distances/AoAs values measured on the reference signals, such that values can result in different secret keys. For example, d_1 can give a secret key that is different from $d_1=5$. Order of distances/AoAs—order of estimated paths information—can be based on time to receive each reference signal (or based on agreement between the devices to process each RS). For example, the set of path information {P1, P2} can give a secret key that is different from {P2, P1}. Combination of paths {P1, P2} can give a secret key that is different from {P1, P3}.

(73) In method **600**, optionally Block **608**, the secret key can be generated based at least in part on applying a function of the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals. In an aspect, securing component **454**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, BS communicating component **442**, etc., can generate the secret key based at least in part on applying the function of the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals. In an example, securing component **454** can apply the function of path information using an order of path information indicated by the UE **104**, as the transmitting device, in signaling reference signals or other information to the receiving device, as described above. In addition, for example, securing component **454** can apply the function of path information using certain values that may be configured between the devices or otherwise known. As described, for example, securing component **454** can use at least one of values of the exact path information transmitted to the transmitting device, labels or identifiers (e.g., the reference signal identifiers), or a combination thereof to generate the secret key. In any case, for example, the transmitting device and receiving device can use the same values and the same function to generate the secret key, which can result in the devices generate the same secret key. This secret key can then be used to secure communications between the devices.

(74) For example, in method **600**, optionally at Block **610**, communications for transmitting to the receiving device can be encoded, based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals. In an aspect, securing

component **454**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, BS communicating component **442**, etc., can encode, based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals, communications for transmitting to the receiving device. For example, securing component **454** can sign the communications at the PHY layer using the secret key to maintain authentication or integrity. In one example, securing component **454** can sign a hashed value representing the path or path information, or can sign just the value of the path or path information without hashing, or can sign one or more of quantities of the path (e.g., distance, pathloss, AoA, ToA, etc.) or can jointly sign (without or with hashing) the value of the path along with some path information (e.g., distance pathloss, AoA, ToA, etc.).

(75) In one specific example, securing component **454** can encode the communications using a commitment scheme (e.g., cryptographic commitment), which may leverage a Pederson commitment (e.g., based on hardness of discrete log problems and/or unconditionally hiding and computationally binding). In this example, as a precondition, public parameters (p,g,h) can be shared with the UEs (e.g., via L1/L2/L3 signaling, where L3 may provide some level of security). In this example, p can be a large prime, g can be a number in $[2, p-1]$, and h can be an element in $[2, p-1]$ such that $\log_g h$ is unknown. In this example, securing component **454** can provide $g.\text{sup.IDh}.\text{sup.r} \bmod p$ as a commitment of path information, where ID is path information with a timestamp and/or scrambling IDs from the network node (or from a controlling UE in sidelink communications). Sequence and r can be random numbers. The commitment of path information can be provided to the UE using L1/L2/L3 signaling. In this example, securing component **454** can broadcast r. In addition, securing component **454** can transmit r together with the corresponding channel bits transmission (e.g., for data or control channel with channel coding as probabilistic amplitude shaping (PAS)). The UE can verify the committed value after receiving the channel and r.

(76) In another specific example, securing component **454** can encode the communications using a Pederson commitment with Fiat-Shamir scheme, which may leverage zero-knowledge proof (ZKP) based on hardness of discrete log problems and/or unconditionally hiding and computationally binding, where the secret may not be shared with UEs. In this example, securing component **454** can have a private key x and public value $y=g.\text{sup.x} \bmod p$, where g can be the generator of the multiplicative group of integers modulo p. The securing component **454** can select a random v and can compute $t=g.\text{sup.v}$. The securing component **454** can also compute $c=H(g,y,t, \text{ID})$, where $H(\)$ is a cryptographic hash function, and $r=v-cx$. The proof is the pair (t,r); ($g.\text{sup.v}$, $v-cx$). In this example, the UE **104** in decoding the communication can calculate $c=H(g,y,t, \text{ID})$ and check whether $t=g.\text{sup.rg}.\text{sup.xc}=g.\text{sup.v}$. If so, the UE can verify the communication. This can provide a flexible and secure operation where each network node can calculate c while a dedicated function that holds a secret x can compute (t,r). This may be an efficient signature scheme in terms of signature size being considered (e.g., Boneh Lynn Shacham (BLS) signature based on Bilinear pairing on EC may require 256 bits).

(77) In yet another specific example, securing component **454** can encode the communications with a digital signature using Rivest Shamir Adleman (RSA). In this example, message m can be encrypted, and can include pathloss information, for example. Securing component **454**, for example, can compute $H.\text{sub.m}=\text{Hash}(m)$ to add further security and compressed size. Securing component **454** can sign $H.\text{sub.m}$, e.g., $\text{sign}.\text{sub.m}=(H.\text{sub.m}).\text{sup.d} \bmod n$, and can transmit m and $\text{sign}.\text{sub.m}$, along with encrypted data signal which is sent into direction of same path. In this example, the UE **104** can decode/determine m, Hash m to get $H.\text{sub.m}=\text{Hash}(m)$, determine $\text{sign}.\text{sub.m}$, and apply public key e, i.e., $(\text{sign}.\text{sub.m}).\text{sup.e}=(H.\text{sub.m}).\text{sup.de} \bmod n=H.\text{sub.m}$. If $H.\text{sub.m}=(H.\text{sub.m}).\text{sup.de} \bmod n$, then the message m is authenticated, it is coming from the network node owning the private key d.

(78) For example, in method **600**, optionally at Block **612**, communications can be transmitted to

the receiving device. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can transmit the communications, as secured, to the receiving device.

(79) For example, in method **500**, optionally at Block **512**, communications can be received from the transmitting device. In an aspect, UE communicating component **342**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, etc., can receive the communications, as secured, from the transmitting device. For example, in method **500**, optionally at Block **514**, communications received from the transmitting device can be decoded, based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals. In an aspect, securing component **354**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can decode, based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals, communications received from the transmitting device. For example, securing component **354** can decode the communications received through the path at least in part by determining the path information used to transmit the communications (e.g., by using an example DMRS associated with communications). In an example, securing component **354** can determine the path based on determining distance, pathloss, AoA, ToA, etc., and/or performing some comparison with acceptable error (e.g., securing component **354** may be configured with some agreed criterion such as minimum square error between measured value of a quantity and the stored value. As the UE **104** can have stored values for path information of different paths, as described above, securing component **354** can compare the determined path with the signed communications (which indicates the path) to verify the communications. In an example, securing component **354** can decode the communications using one or more of the processes outlined above for cryptographic commitment, Pederson commitment with Fiat-Shamir scheme, or digital signature using RSA. This can maintain authentication or integrity for the communications.

(80) In another example, in method **500**, optionally at Block **516**, communications for transmitting to the transmitting device can be encoded, based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals. In an aspect, securing component **354**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can encode, based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals, communications for transmitting to the transmitting device. For example, securing component **354** can sign the communications at the PHY layer using the secret key. For example, in method **500**, optionally at Block **518**, communications can be transmitted to the transmitting device. In an aspect, UE communicating component **342**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, etc., can transmit the communications, as secured, to the transmitting device.

(81) For example, in method **600**, optionally at Block **614**, communications can be received from the receiving device. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can receive the communications, as secured, from the receiving device. For example, in method **600**, optionally at Block **616**, communications received from the receiving device can be decoded, based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals. In an aspect, securing component **454**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, BS communicating component **442**, etc., can decode, based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals, communications received from the receiving device.

(82) FIG. **8** illustrates a flow chart of an example of a method **800** for authenticating physical layer communications based on estimated path information, in accordance with aspects described herein. FIG. **9** illustrates a flow chart of an example of a method **900** for including information for authenticating physical layer communications based on received path information, in accordance

with aspects described herein. In an example, a UE **104** can perform the functions described in method **800** using one or more of the components described in FIGS. **1** and **3**, and a base station **102** or another UE (e.g., in sidelink communications with UE **104**) can perform the functions described in method **900** using one or more of the components described in FIGS. **1** and **4**. Methods **800** and **900** are described in conjunction with one another for ease of explanation. These methods, however, are not required to be performed in conjunction with one another, and different devices can be configured to perform the methods without requiring the other device.

(83) In method **900**, at Block **902**, multiple reference signals can be transmitted, to a receiving device, over multiple different paths. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can transmit, to the receiving device, multiple reference signals over multiple different paths, as described above in reference to Block **602** in method **600** of FIG. **6**.

(84) In method **800**, optionally at Block **802**, multiple reference signals can be received, from a transmitting device, over multiple different paths. In an aspect, UE communicating component **342**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, etc., can receive, from the transmitting device (e.g., a base station **102** or another UE), the multiple reference signals over the multiple different paths, as described above in reference to Block **502** in method **500** of FIG. **5**.

(85) In method **800**, at Block **804**, path information for each of multiple reference signals received over one of multiple different paths from a transmitting device can be generated. In an aspect, path information component **352**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can generate the path information for each of multiple reference signals received over one of multiple different paths from the transmitting device, as described above in reference to Block **504** in method **500** of FIG. **5**.

(86) In method **900**, at Block **904**, communications can be transmitted, to the receiving device, over one of the multiple different paths, where the communications include a parameter indicating one of the multiple different paths over which the communications are transmitted. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can transmit, to the receiving device, communications over one of the multiple different paths, where the communications can include the parameter indicating the one of the multiple different paths over which the communications are transmitted. For example, authentication information component **456** can insert the parameter in the communications, which indicates the path over which the communications are transmitted. For example, referring to FIG. **7**, authentication information component **456** can include the parameter in the communications indicating whether the communications are transmitted over Path **1** or Path **2** (or using an associated beam **704** or **706**).

(87) In this example, path information can be used to authenticate the received message, as described further herein. For example, with each downlink control information (DCI), sidelink control information (SCI), physical sidelink shared channel (PSSCH), physical downlink shared channel (PDSCH), physical uplink shared channel (PUSCH), etc., the transmitting device can send the route/path information to final destination. For example, the transmitting device can use the beam that direct the signal to the forwarding signal, which can forward the signal to the receiving device's direction and results in a certain overall distance/pathloss of X and certain AoA Y at the receiving device. This information can be used to verify that the signal came from the path indicated in the signal.

(88) In method **800**, at Block **806**, communications received from the transmitting device can be authenticated based on comparing received path information of the communications with path information for one of the multiple different paths indicated for the communications. In an aspect, authenticating component **356**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can authenticate the communications received from the transmitted device based on comparing received path information of the communications (e.g.,

path information observed of the communications) with path information for one of the multiple different paths indicated for the communications (e.g., path information as generated at Block **804** for the path indicated for the communications. For example, authenticating component **356** can generate path information for the received communications, such as distance, ToA, pathloss, AoA, etc., and can determine whether this path information matches, or is at least within a threshold difference of, the path information generated, at Block **804**, for the path indicated in the communications.

(89) In method **800**, optionally at Block **808**, it can be determined whether there is a failure in authenticating the communications. In an aspect, authenticating component **356**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can determine whether there is a failure in authenticating the communications. For example, authenticating component **356** can determine failure where there is a discrepancy (or at least a threshold difference) between the path information previously generated for the path indicated in the communications and the path information observed for the communications.

(90) In an example, if a failure in authenticating is detected at Block **808**, optionally at Block **810**, the communications can be discarded. In an aspect, authenticating component **356**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can discard the communications, as received, based on the authentication failure. In another example, if a failure in authenticating is detected at Block **808**, optionally at Block **812**, retransmission of the communications can be requested. In an aspect, authenticating component **356**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can request retransmission of the communications from the transmitting device based on the authentication failure. In another example, if a failure in authenticating is detected at Block **808**, optionally at Block **814**, a flag indication associated with acknowledgement (ACK)/negative-ACK (NACK), can be transmitted. In an aspect, authenticating component **356**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can transmit a flag indication associated with ACK/NACK of the communications based on the authentication failure (if the communications are data communications) or in separate feedback resources. In these examples, the UE **104** can discard the communications.

(91) In this example, in method **900**, optionally at Block **906**, an indication of detecting failure in authenticating communications can be received from the receiving device. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can receive, from the receiving device, the indication of detecting failure in authenticating communications. For example, the indication can include a request for retransmission, the flag indication associated with ACK/NACK for the communications, etc. In any case, for example, optionally at Block **908**, the communications can be retransmitted to the receiving device based on the indication. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can retransmit, based on the indication, the communications to the receiving device.

(92) In one example in method **900**, optionally at Block **910**, a different path can be selected, a process can be reestablished, or more security layers can be added before transmitting the communications. In an aspect, BS communicating component **442**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **412**, memory **416**, transceiver **402**, etc., can select a different path for communications (e.g., Path **1** where the communications were previously transmitted over Path **2**), or can reestablish a process for transmitting communications, or can add more security layers for transmitting the communications before retransmitting the communications. This can be in response to the indication of authentication failure. In an example, selecting a different path or reestablishing the process can improve hearability of the retransmission, where the initial transmission at Block **904** is not properly received. In another example, adding more security layers

can further protect from malicious communications, where the receiving device receives a communication from a different transmitting device (based on a discrepancy in observed path information).

(93) In another example, referring to FIG. 8, the UE **104**, as the receiving device, can process the communications and can send an alert. In method **800**, optionally at Block **816**, an alert can be transmitted. In an aspect, authenticating component **356**, e.g., in conjunction with processor(s) **312**, memory **316**, transceiver **302**, UE communicating component **342**, etc., can transmit an alert to the transmitting device to indicate the failure in authenticating.

(94) In one example, one or more of the actions in Blocks **810**, **812**, **814**, **816** can be performed when there are a certain number of failures in authenticating a given communication (e.g., based on additional subsequent failures in authenticating retransmissions of the communication). In method **800**, optionally at Block **818**, it can be determined whether the number of failures achieves a threshold. If so, one or more of Blocks **810**, **812**, **814**, **816** can be performed. For example, where an alert is transmitted at Block **816**, this alert can be sent after each transmission associated with ACK/NACK of the message (if the message is a data message) or in a separate feedback resources. In another example, this alert can be sent after authentication fails the threshold number of times, where the transmitting device can configure the threshold for the receiving device to use. For example, the transmitting device can configure the threshold as a parameter in a layer 1 (e.g., PHY layer, such as in downlink control information (DCI)), layer 2 (e.g., MAC layer, such as in MAC-control element (CE)), layer 3 (e.g., RRC layer, such as in a RRC signal), etc. configuration. In another example, the alert can be sent where authentication fails a threshold number of times within a configured time window (e.g., where the number of failure achieve the threshold at Block **818** within the configured time window). For example, the configured time window can include a number of slots, a number of milliseconds, etc. In an example, the transmitting device can configure the threshold and/or the time window as a parameter in a layer 1, 2, or 3 configuration.

(95) FIG. **10** is a block diagram of a MIMO communication system **1000** including a base station **102** and a UE **104**. The MIMO communication system **1000** may illustrate aspects of the wireless communication access network **100** described with reference to FIG. **1**. The base station **102** may be an example of aspects of the base station **102** described with reference to FIG. **1**. The base station **102** may be equipped with antennas **1034** and **1035**, and the UE **104** may be equipped with antennas **1052** and **1053**. In the MIMO communication system **1000**, the base station **102** may be able to send data over multiple communication links at the same time. Each communication link may be called a “layer” and the “rank” of the communication link may indicate the number of layers used for communication. For example, in a 2×2 MIMO communication system where base station **102** transmits two “layers,” the rank of the communication link between the base station **102** and the UE **104** is two.

(96) At the base station **102**, a transmit (Tx) processor **1020** may receive data from a data source. The transmit processor **1020** may process the data. The transmit processor **1020** may also generate control symbols or reference symbols. A transmit MIMO processor **1030** may perform spatial processing (e.g., precoding) on data symbols, control symbols, or reference symbols, if applicable, and may provide output symbol streams to the transmit modulator/demodulators **1032** and **1033**. Each modulator/demodulator **1032** through **1033** may process a respective output symbol stream (e.g., for OFDM, etc.) to obtain an output sample stream. Each modulator/demodulator **1032** through **1033** may further process (e.g., convert to analog, amplify, filter, and upconvert) the output sample stream to obtain a DL signal. In one example, DL signals from modulator/demodulators **1032** and **1033** may be transmitted via the antennas **1034** and **1035**, respectively.

(97) The UE **104** may be an example of aspects of the UEs **104** described with reference to FIGS. **1-2**. At the UE **104**, the UE antennas **1052** and **1053** may receive the DL signals from the base station **102** and may provide the received signals to the modulator/demodulators **1054** and **1055**, respectively. Each modulator/demodulator **1054** through **1055** may condition (e.g., filter, amplify,

downconvert, and digitize) a respective received signal to obtain input samples. Each modulator/demodulator **1054** through **1055** may further process the input samples (e.g., for OFDM, etc.) to obtain received symbols. A MIMO detector **1056** may obtain received symbols from the modulator/demodulators **1054** and **1055**, perform MIMO detection on the received symbols, if applicable, and provide detected symbols. A receive (Rx) processor **1058** may process (e.g., demodulate, deinterleave, and decode) the detected symbols, providing decoded data for the UE **104** to a data output, and provide decoded control information to a processor **1080**, or memory **1082**.

(98) The processor **1080** may in some cases execute stored instructions to instantiate a UE communicating component **342** (see e.g., FIGS. **1** and **2**).

(99) On the uplink (UL), at the UE **104**, a transmit processor **1064** may receive and process data from a data source. The transmit processor **1064** may also generate reference symbols for a reference signal. The symbols from the transmit processor **1064** may be precoded by a transmit MIMO processor **1066** if applicable, further processed by the modulator/demodulators **1054** and **1055** (e.g., for SC-FDMA, etc.), and be transmitted to the base station **102** in accordance with the communication parameters received from the base station **102**. At the base station **102**, the UL signals from the UE **104** may be received by the antennas **1034** and **1035**, processed by the modulator/demodulators **1032** and **1033**, detected by a MIMO detector **1036** if applicable, and further processed by a receive processor **1038**. The receive processor **1038** may provide decoded data to a data output and to the processor **1040** or memory **1042**.

(100) The processor **1040** may in some cases execute stored instructions to instantiate a BS communicating component **442** (see e.g., FIGS. **1** and **3**).

(101) The components of the UE **104** may, individually or collectively, be implemented with one or more ASICs adapted to perform some or all of the applicable functions in hardware. Each of the noted modules may be a means for performing one or more functions related to operation of the MIMO communication system **1000**. Similarly, the components of the base station **102** may, individually or collectively, be implemented with one or more application specific integrated circuits (ASICs) adapted to perform some or all of the applicable functions in hardware. Each of the noted components may be a means for performing one or more functions related to operation of the MIMO communication system **1000**.

(102) The following aspects are illustrative only and aspects thereof may be combined with aspects of other embodiments or teachings described herein, without limitation.

(103) Aspect 1 is a method for wireless communication including generating, by a receiving device, path information for each of multiple reference signals received over one of multiple different paths from a transmitting device, and at least one of: decoding communications received from the transmitting device based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals; encoding communications for transmitting to the transmitting device based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals; or authenticating communications received from the transmitting device based on comparing received path information of the communications with the path information for one of the multiple different paths indicated for the communications.

(104) In Aspect 2, the method of Aspect 1 includes where the path information for a given reference signal of the multiple reference signals includes at least one of a pathloss computed for the given reference signal, a time-of-arrival of the given reference signal, or an angle-of-arrival for the given reference signal.

(105) In Aspect 3, the method of any of Aspects 1 or 2 includes transmitting, to the transmitting device, the path information generated for each of the multiple reference signals.

(106) In Aspect 4, the method of Aspect 3 includes generating the secret key based at least in part on applying a function of the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals in

an order.

(107) In Aspect 5, the method of Aspect 4 includes where the order is based on receiving each of the multiple reference signals from the transmitting device.

(108) In Aspect 6, the method of any of Aspects 4 or 5 includes receiving, from the transmitting device, an indication of the order.

(109) In Aspect 7, the method of any of Aspects 1 to 6 includes where the communications include a parameter indicating the one of the multiple different paths used to transmit the communications.

(110) In Aspect 8, the method of any of Aspects 1 to 7 includes where authenticating the communications includes detecting failure in authenticating where the received path information of the communications does not match the path information generated for the one of the multiple different paths indicated for the communications.

(111) In Aspect 9, the method of Aspect 8 includes discarding the communications based on detecting the failure in authenticating.

(112) In Aspect 10, the method of any of Aspects 8 or 9 includes requesting, from the transmitting device, retransmission of the communications based on detecting the failure in authenticating.

(113) In Aspect 11, the method of any of Aspects 8 to 10 includes transmitting, to the transmitting device, a flag indication associated with ACK/NACK based on detecting the failure in authenticating.

(114) In Aspect 12, the method of any of Aspects 8 to 11 includes transmitting, to the transmitting device, an alert after each transmission of the communications received based on transmitting feedback, based on detecting the failure in authenticating each transmission.

(115) In Aspect 13, the method of any of Aspects 8 to 12 includes transmitting, to the transmitting device, an alert after detecting failure in authenticating a number of transmissions of the communications, where the number is configured via downlink control information, MAC-CE, or RRC.

(116) In Aspect 14, the method of any of Aspects 8 to 13 includes transmitting, to the transmitting device, an alert after detecting failure in authenticating a number of transmissions of the communications within a time window, where at least one of the number or the time window is configured via downlink control information, MAC-CE, or RRC.

(117) Aspect 15 is a method for wireless communication including transmitting, to a receiving device, multiple reference signals over multiple different paths, receiving, from the receiving device, path information for each of the multiple reference signals, and at least one of: encoding, based on a secret key generated from at least a portion of the path information for at least a portion of the multiple reference signals, communications for transmitting to the receiving device; decoding, based on the secret key generated from at least the portion of the path information for at least the portion of the multiple reference signals, communications received from the receiving device; or transmitting, to the receiving device, communications over one of the multiple different paths, where the communications include a parameter indicating the one of the multiple different paths over which the communications are transmitted.

(118) In Aspect 16, the method of Aspect 15 includes where the path information for a given reference signal of the multiple reference signals includes at least one of a pathloss computed for the given reference signal, a time-of-arrival of the given reference signal, or an angle-of-arrival for the given reference signal.

(119) In Aspect 17, the method of any of Aspects 15 or 16 includes generating the secret key based at least in part on applying, via a function, the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals in an order.

(120) In Aspect 18, the method of Aspect 17 includes where the order is based on transmitting each of the multiple reference signals to the receiving device.

(121) In Aspect 19, the method of any of Aspects 17 or 18 includes transmitting, to the receiving device, an indication of the order.

(122) In Aspect 20, the method of any of Aspects 15 to 19 includes receiving, from the receiving device, an indication of detecting failure in authenticating the communications, and retransmitting, based on the indication, the communications to the receiving device.

(123) In Aspect 21, the method of Aspect 20 includes transmitting, to the receiving device, a configuration indicating one or more parameters for triggering reporting of detecting of the failure in authenticating.

(124) In Aspect 22, the method of Aspect 21 includes where the one or more parameters include one or more of a number of transmissions for which the failure in authenticating is detected to trigger the reporting, or a time window within which failure in authenticating is detected for the number of transmissions to trigger the reporting.

(125) Aspect 23 is an apparatus for wireless communication including a transceiver, a memory configured to store instructions, and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the memory and the transceiver, where the one or more processors are configured to execute the instructions to cause the apparatus to perform any of the methods of Aspects 1 to 22.

(126) Aspect 24 is an apparatus for wireless communication including means for performing any of the methods of Aspects 1 to 22.

(127) Aspect 25 is a computer-readable medium including code executable by one or more processors for wireless communications, the code including code for performing any of the methods of Aspects 1 to 22.

(128) The above detailed description set forth above in connection with the appended drawings describes examples and does not represent the only examples that may be implemented or that are within the scope of the claims. The term “example,” when used in this description, means “serving as an example, instance, or illustration,” and not “preferred” or “advantageous over other examples.” The detailed description includes specific details for the purpose of providing an understanding of the described techniques. These techniques, however, may be practiced without these specific details. In some instances, well-known structures and apparatuses are shown in block diagram form in order to avoid obscuring the concepts of the described examples.

(129) Information and signals may be represented using any of a variety of different technologies and techniques. For example, data, instructions, commands, information, signals, bits, symbols, and chips that may be referenced throughout the above description may be represented by voltages, currents, electromagnetic waves, magnetic fields or particles, optical fields or particles, computer-executable code or instructions stored on a computer-readable medium, or any combination thereof.

(130) The various illustrative blocks and components described in connection with the disclosure herein may be implemented or performed with a specially programmed device, such as but not limited to a processor, a digital signal processor (DSP), an ASIC, a field programmable gate array (FPGA) or other programmable logic device, a discrete gate or transistor logic, a discrete hardware component, or any combination thereof designed to perform the functions described herein. A specially programmed processor may be a microprocessor, but in the alternative, the processor may be any conventional processor, controller, microcontroller, or state machine. A specially programmed processor may also be implemented as a combination of computing devices, e.g., a combination of a DSP and a microprocessor, multiple microprocessors, one or more microprocessors in conjunction with a DSP core, or any other such configuration.

(131) The functions described herein may be implemented in hardware, software executed by a processor, firmware, or any combination thereof. If implemented in software executed by a processor, the functions may be stored on or transmitted over as one or more instructions or code on a non-transitory computer-readable medium. Other examples and implementations are within the scope and spirit of the disclosure and appended claims. For example, due to the nature of software, functions described above can be implemented using software executed by a specially programmed processor, hardware, firmware, hardwiring, or combinations of any of these. Features implementing functions may also be physically located at various positions, including being

distributed such that portions of functions are implemented at different physical locations. Also, as used herein, including in the claims, “or” as used in a list of items prefaced by “at least one of” indicates a disjunctive list such that, for example, a list of “at least one of A, B, or C” means A or B or C or AB or AC or BC or ABC (i.e., A and B and C).

(132) Computer-readable media includes both computer storage media and communication media including any medium that facilitates transfer of a computer program from one place to another. A storage medium may be any available medium that can be accessed by a general purpose or special purpose computer. By way of example, and not limitation, computer-readable media can comprise RAM, ROM, EEPROM, CD-ROM or other optical disk storage, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium that can be used to carry or store desired program code means in the form of instructions or data structures and that can be accessed by a general-purpose or special-purpose computer, or a general-purpose or special-purpose processor. Also, any connection is properly termed a computer-readable medium. For example, if the software is transmitted from a website, server, or other remote source using a coaxial cable, fiber optic cable, twisted pair, digital subscriber line (DSL), or wireless technologies such as infrared, radio, and microwave, then the coaxial cable, fiber optic cable, twisted pair, DSL, or wireless technologies such as infrared, radio, and microwave are included in the definition of medium. Disk and disc, as used herein, include compact disc (CD), laser disc, optical disc, digital versatile disc (DVD), floppy disk and Blu-ray disc where disks usually reproduce data magnetically, while discs reproduce data optically with lasers. Combinations of the above are also included within the scope of computer-readable media.

(133) The previous description of the disclosure is provided to enable a person skilled in the art to make or use the disclosure. Various modifications to the disclosure will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the common principles defined herein may be applied to other variations without departing from the spirit or scope of the disclosure. Furthermore, although elements of the described aspects and/or embodiments may be described or claimed in the singular, the plural is contemplated unless limitation to the singular is explicitly stated. Additionally, all or a portion of any aspect and/or embodiment may be utilized with all or a portion of any other aspect and/or embodiment, unless stated otherwise. Thus, the disclosure is not to be limited to the examples and designs described herein but is to be accorded the widest scope consistent with the principles and novel features disclosed herein.

Claims

1. An apparatus for wireless communication, comprising: a transceiver; a memory configured to store instructions; and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the memory and the transceiver, wherein the one or more processors are configured to: generate path information for each of multiple reference signals received over a different one of multiple different paths from a transmitting device, wherein each of the multiple different paths is based on a different transmit beam used by the transmitting device and is associated with a different angle-of-arrival at the apparatus, and wherein the path information for a given reference signal of the multiple reference signals includes at least one of a pathloss computed for the given reference signal, a time-of-arrival of the given reference signal, or an angle-of-arrival for the given reference signal; transmit, to the transmitting device, the path information generated for each of the multiple reference signals; receive, from the transmitting device, an indication of an ordering for applying the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals to generate a secret key; and at least one of: decode communications received in a signal from the transmitting device based on the secret key; or encode communications for transmitting in a signal to the transmitting device based on the secret key.

2. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the one or more processors are further configured to generate

- the secret key based at least in part on applying a function of the path information for the two or more of the multiple reference signals based on the ordering.
3. The apparatus of claim 2, wherein the ordering is based on a receiving order of receiving each of the two or more of the multiple reference signals from the transmitting device.
 4. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the communications include a parameter indicating one of the multiple different paths used to transmit the communications.
 5. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the one or more processors are configured further to authenticate the communications received in a signal from the transmitting device based on comparing received path information observed for the communications with the path information for one of the multiple different paths indicated in the communications.
 6. The apparatus of claim 5, wherein the one or more processors are configured to authenticate the communications including detecting failure in authenticating where the received path information of the communications does not match the path information.
 7. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein the one or more processors are configured further to discard the communications based on detecting the failure in authenticating.
 8. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein the one or more processors are configured to request, from the transmitting device, retransmission of the communications based on detecting the failure in authenticating.
 9. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein the one or more processors are further configured to transmit, to the transmitting device, a flag indication associated with acknowledgement (ACK)/negative-ACK (NACK) based on detecting the failure in authenticating.
 10. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein the one or more processors are further configured to transmit, to the transmitting device, an alert after each transmission of the communications received based on transmitting feedback, based on detecting the failure in authenticating each transmission.
 11. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein the one or more processors are further configured to transmit, to the transmitting device, an alert after detecting failure in authenticating a number of transmissions of the communications, wherein the number is configured via downlink control information, media access control (MAC)-control element (CE), or radio resource control (RRC) signaling.
 12. The apparatus of claim 6, wherein the one or more processors are further configured to transmit, to the transmitting device, an alert after detecting failure in authenticating a number of transmissions of the communications within a time window, wherein at least one of the number or the time window is configured via downlink control information, media access control (MAC)-control element (CE), or radio resource control (RRC) signaling.
 13. A method for wireless communication, comprising: generating, by a receiving device, path information for each of multiple reference signals received over a different one of multiple different paths from a transmitting device, wherein each of the multiple different paths is based on a different transmit beam used by the transmitting device and is associated with a different angle-of-arrival at the receiving device, and wherein the path information for a given reference signal of the multiple reference signals includes at least one of a pathloss computed for the given reference signal, a time-of-arrival of the given reference signal, or an angle-of-arrival for the given reference signal; transmitting, to the transmitting device, the path information generated for each of the multiple reference signals; receiving, from the transmitting device, an indication of an ordering for applying the path information for two or more of the multiple reference signals to generate a secret key; and at least one of: decoding communications received in a signal from the transmitting device based on the secret key; or encoding communications for transmitting in a signal to the transmitting device based on the secret key.
 14. The method of claim 13, further comprising generating the secret key based at least in part on applying a function of the path information for the two or more of the multiple reference signals

based on the ordering.

15. The method of claim 13, wherein the communications include a parameter indicating one of the multiple different paths used to transmit the communications.

16. The method of claim 13, further comprising authenticating the communications received in a signal from the transmitting device based on comparing received path information observed for the communications with the path information for one of the multiple different paths indicated in the communications.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein authenticating the communications includes detecting failure in authenticating where the received path information of the communications does not match the path information generated for one of the multiple different paths indicated for the communications.
